

0.0.1 The Triple Knowledge (excerpt)

1. Thus was heard by me: At one time the Auspicious One was wandering on tour in Kosala with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with about five hundred bhikkhus, when they arrived at a brahmin village of the Kosalans named Manasakata. There the Auspicious One dwelled at a mango grove north of Manasakata on the bank of the Aciravati river.

2. At that time many well-known wealthy brahmins were dwelling at Manasakata, such as: the brahmin Canki, the brahmin Tarukkha, the brahmin Pokkharasati, the brahmin Janussoṇi, the brahmin Todeyya, and many other well-known and wealthy brahmins.

3. Now for Vasettha and Bharadvaja, while walking and wandering about, walking along back and forth, this topic of conversation about path and non-path arose. Then the brahmin youth Vasettha said thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Pokkharasati.”

4. The brahmin youth Bharadvaja said thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin

0.0.1 tevijjasuttam (excerpt)

1. evammesutaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā kosalesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ pañcamattehi bhikkhusatehi yena manasākaṭaṃ nāma kosalānaṃ brāhmaṇagāmo tadavasari. tatra sudam bhagavā manasākaṭe viharati uttarena manasākaṭassa aciravatiyā nadiyā tīre ambavane.

2. tena kho pana samayena sambahulā abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā manasākaṭe paṭivasanti, seyyathidaṃ: caṅkī brāhmaṇo, tārukko brāhmaṇo, pokkharasāti brāhmaṇo, jāṇussoṇī brāhmaṇo, todeyyo brāhmaṇo, aññe ca abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā.

3. atha kho vāsetṭha-bhāradvājānaṃ jaṅghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamantānaṃ anuvicarantānaṃ maggāmagge kathā udapādi. atha kho vāsetṭho māṇavo evamāha: ‘ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena pokkharasātinā’ti.

4. bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena tārukkenā’ti. neva khvāsakkhi¹ vāsetṭho māṇavo bhāradvājaṃ māṇavaṃ saññāpetuṃ. na panāsakkhi bhāradvājo māṇavo vāsetṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ saññāpetuṃ.

Tarukkha.” Neither was the brahmin youth Vasettha able to convince the brahmin youth Bharadvaja, nor was the brahmin youth Bharadvaja able to convince the brahmin youth Vasettha.

5. So then, the brahmin youth Vasettha address the brahmin youth, Bharadvaja. Master Bharadvaja, there is this samana Gotama, son of the Sakyans who has gone forth from the Sakyan clan, dwelling at Manasakata, in a mango grove north of Manasakata on the bank of the Aciravati river. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” We must visit with the samana Gotama, O Master Bharadvaja. Upon arrival, we must ask the samana Gotama about this matter. In which ever way the samana Gotama will answer, in just that way we must bear it in mind.” “Yes sir.” The brahmin youth Bharadvaja replied to the brahmin youth Vasettha.

6. So then, the brahmin youths Vasettha and Bharadvaja visited with the Auspicious One. Having approached, they exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchanged friendly greetings and cordial talk, they sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin youth Vasettha said this to the Auspi-

5. atha kho vāseṭṭho māṇavo bhāradvājaṃ māṇavaṃ āmantesi: ayaṃ kho bhāradvāja, samaṇo gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito manasākaṭe viharati uttarena manasākaṭassa aciravatiyā nadiyā tīre ambavane. taṃ kho pana bhavantam gotamaṃ evaṃ kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: itipi so bhagavā araham sammāsambuddho vijjācaraṇasampanno sugato lokavidū anuttaro purisadammasārathi satthā devamanussānaṃ buddho bhagavā'ti. āyāma bho bhāradvāja, yena samaṇo gotamo tenupasaṅkamissāma. upasaṅkamitvā etamatthaṃ samaṇaṃ gotamaṃ pucchissāma. yathā no samaṇo gotamo byākarissati, tathā naṃ dhāressāmāti. 'evambho'ti kho bhāradvājo māṇavo vāseṭṭhassa māṇavassa paccassosi.

6. atha kho vāseṭṭhabhāradvājā māṇavā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkamsu. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavatā saddhiṃ sammodimsu. sammodanīyaṃ kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vītisāretvā ekamantaṃ nisīdimsu. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho vāseṭṭho māṇavo bhagavantam etadavoca: "idha bho gotama amhākaṃ jaṅghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamantānaṃ anuvicarantānaṃ maggāmagge kathā udapādi. ahaṃ evaṃ vadāmi: 'ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena pokkharasātinā'ti. bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: 'ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena tārukkenā'ti. ettha bho gotama, attheva viggaho atthi vivādo, atthi nānāvādo"ti.

cious One: “Here Master Gotama, for us while walking and wandering about, walking along back and forth, this topic of conversation about path and non-path arose. I said thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Pokkharasati.” The brahmin youth Bharadvaja said thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Tarukkha.” Here Master Gotama, there is really a dispute, there is a contention, there is a difference of views.”

7. Thus apparently, O Vasettha, you say thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Pokkharasati.” The brahmin youth Bharadvaja say thus: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma, which is this [path] declared by the brahmin Tarukkha.” But what, O Vasettha, is your dispute, what is the contention, what is the difference of views?”

8. “About path and non-path, O Master Gotama. Even though, O Master Gotama, the brahmins declare various paths: that of the Addhariya brahmins, the Tittiriya brah-

7. “iti kira vāseṭṭha, tvaṃ evaṃ vadesi: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena pokkharasātinā’ti. bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya yvāyaṃ akkhāto brāhmaṇena tārukkenāti. atha kismiṃ pana vo vāseṭṭhā viggaho? kismiṃ vivādo? kismiṃ nānāvādo?”ti.

8. “maggāmagge bho gotama. kiñcāpi bho gotama brāhmaṇā nānāmagge paññāpenti addhariyā brāhmaṇā, tittiriyā brāhmaṇā. chandokā brāhmaṇā, bavhircā1 brāhmaṇā, atha kho sabbāni tāni niyyāṇikāni niyyanti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāya. seyyathāpi bho gotama gāmassa vā nigamassa vā avidūre bahūni cepi nānāmaggāni bhavanti, atha kho sabbāni tāni gāmasamosaraṇāni bhavanti. evameva kho bho gotama kiñcāpi brāhmaṇā nānāmagge paññāpenti addhariyā brāhmaṇā, tittiriyā brāhmaṇā, chandokā brāhmaṇā, bavhircā brāhmaṇā, atha kho sabbāni tāni niyyāṇikāni niyyanti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāyā”ti.

9. “niyyantīti vāseṭṭha vadesi?”

10. “niyyantīti bho gotama vadāmi”.

11. “niyyantīti vāseṭṭha vadesi?”

12. “niyyantīti bho gotama vadāmi”.

mins, the Chandoka brahmins, the Bavhirica brahmins, they all lead to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma. Just as, O Master Gotama, not too far from a village or market town, even if there are various paths, all converge on the village. So too, O Master Gotama, even though the brahmins declare various paths: that of the Addhariya brahmins, the Tittiriya brahmins, the Chandoka brahmins, the Bavhirica brahmins, they all lead to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma.”

9. Do you say, “delivering,” O Vasettha?

10. I say, “delivering,” O Master Gotama.

11. Do you say, “delivering,” O Vasettha?

12. I say, “delivering,” O Master Gotama.

13. Do you say, “delivering,” O Vasettha?

14. I say, “delivering,” O Master Gotama.

15. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, is there even one brahmin who is able to see Brahma?”

13. “niyyantīti vāseṭṭha vadesi?”

14. “niyyantīti bho gotama vadāmi”.

15. “kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, atthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhma-
ṇānaṃ ekabrāhmaṇo’pi yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho?”ti.

16. “no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

17. “kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, atthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhma-
ṇānaṃ ekācariyo’pi yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho?”ti.

18. “no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

19. “kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, atthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhma-
ṇānaṃ ekācariyapācariyo’pi yena brahmā sakkhidiṭ-
ṭho?”ti.

20. “no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

21. “kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, atthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhma-
ṇānaṃ yāva sattamā ācariyamahayugā yena brahmā
sakkhi diṭṭho?”ti.

22. “no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

16. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

17. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, is there even one teacher who is able to see Brahma?”

18. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

19. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, is there even one teacher of teachers who is able to see Brahma?”

20. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

21. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, is there even one in the seven generations of teachers who is able to see Brahma?”).

22. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

23. “But how about this, O Vasettha. Even the ancient triple-knowledge brahmin seers, composers of the mantras, proclaimers of the mantras, this ancient mantra verses proclaimed and composed [by them], of which at present, the triple-knowledge brahmins chant, recite, rehearse, continuously repeating what was said, causing to pass down what has been recited, that is to say: Attaka,

23. “kiṃ pana vāseṭṭha, ye’pi tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ pubbakā isayo mantānaṃ kattāro mantānaṃ pavattāro yesamidaṃ etarahi tevijjā brāhmaṇā porāṇaṃ mantapadaṃ gītaṃ pavuttaṃ samūhitaṃ tadanugāyanti tadanubhāsanti bhāsitamanubhāsanti vācitanuvinācenti, seyyathidaṃ: aṭṭako vāmakko vāmadevo vessāmitto yamataggi aṅgīraso bhāradvāja vāseṭṭho kassapo bhagu, te’pi evamāhaṃsu: mayametaṃ jānāma mayametaṃ passāma yattha vā brahmā yena vā brahmā yaṃ vā brahmā’ti?”.

24. “no hidaṃ bho gotama”.

25. iti kira vāseṭṭha natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekabrāhmaṇopi yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyopi yena brahmā sakkhidiṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyapācariyopi yena brahmā sakkhidiṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ yāva sattamā ācariyamahayugā yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho -

26. yepi kira tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ pubbakā isayo mantānaṃ kattāro mantānaṃ pavattāro, yesamidaṃ etarahi tevijjā brāhmaṇā porāṇaṃ mantapadaṃ gītaṃ pavuttaṃ samūhitaṃ tadanugāyanti tadanubhāsanti bhāsitamanubhāsanti vācitanuvinācenti, seyyathidaṃ: aṭṭako vāmakko vāmadevo vessāmitto yamataggi aṅgīraso bhāradvāja vāseṭṭho kassapo bhagu, te’pi na evamāhaṃsu: mayametaṃ jānāma mayametaṃ passāma yattha vā brahmā yena vā brahmā yaṃ vā brahmā’ti?”.

Vamaka, Vamadeva, Vessamitta, Yamataggi, Angirasa, Bharadvaja, Vasettha, Kassapa, Bhagu, do they even speak thus: “We know thus, we see thus, how Brahma or when Brahma or where Brahma [appears].”

24. Indeed not, O Master Gotama.

25. Thus apparently, O Vasettha, among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one brahmin who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one teacher who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one teacher of teachers who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one in the seven generations of teachers who is able to see Brahma.

26. Apparently, even the ancient triple-knowledge brahmin seers, composers of the mantras, proclaimers of the mantras, this ancient mantra verses proclaimed and composed [by them], of which at present, the triple-knowledge brahmins chant, recite, rehearse, continuously repeating what was said, causing to pass down what has been recited, that is to say: Attaka, Vamaka, Vamadeva, Vessamitta, Yamataggi, Angirasa, Bharadvaja, Vasettha, Kassapa, Bhagu, even they do not speak thus: “We know thus, we see thus, how Brahma or when Brahma or where Brahma [appears].” Surely those triple-knowledge brahmins who speak thus: “We teach the

hmāti. te vata tevijjā brāhmaṇā evamāhaṃsu: yaṃ mayāṃ na jānāma yaṃ na passāma, tassa sahavyatāya maggaṃ desema: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasahavyatāyāti.

27. taṃ kimmaññasi vāseṭṭha, tanu evaṃ sante tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ appāṭihīrakataṃ bhāsitaṃ sampajjati?ti.

28. addhā kho bho gotama, evaṃ sante tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ appāṭihīrakataṃ bhāsitaṃ sampajjati.

29. sādhu vāseṭṭha. te vata vāseṭṭha tevijjā brāhmaṇā yaṃ na jānanti yaṃ na passanti tassa sahavyatāya maggaṃ desessanti: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāni takkarassa brahmasahavyatāyāti netāṃ ṭhānaṃ vijjati. seyyathāpi vāseṭṭha andhaveṇiparamparaṃ saṃsattā purimopi na passati majjhimopi na passati pacchimopi na passati, evameva kho vāseṭṭha andhaveṇūpamaṃ maññe tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ bhāsitaṃ. purimopi na passati. majjhimopi na passati. pacchimopi na passati. tesamidaṃ tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ bhāsitaṃ bhassakaññeva sampajjati, nāmakaññeva sampajjati. rittakaññeva sampajjati, tucchakaññeva sampajjati.

path to union with that which we do not know, to that which we do not see, this is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma.”

27. “So what do you think, O Vasettha, that being so, doesn’t the statements of those triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be less than stellar?”

28. “Certainly, O Master Gotama, that being so, the statements of those triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be less than stellar.”

29. Good Vasettha. Indeed O Vasettha, that those triple-knowledge brahmins [could] teach a path to union with that which they do not know, that which they do not see, [claiming]: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to emancipation, delivering the doer thereof to union with Brahma,” this possibility is not to be found. Just as, O Vasettha, a line of blind men go on in succession holding on to each other, the first one does not see, the middle one too does not see, the last one too does not see. So too, O Vasettha, the statements of the triple-knowledge brahmins seem to me like a line of blind men; the first one does not see, the middle one too does not see, the last one too does not see. These statements of the triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be mere speech, turn out to be mere words, turn out to be simply empty, turn out to be simply hollow.

